



Scan for Insights

In the End

You can also hire backups for the critical positions and bear the cost. The backups are like the twelfth person in cricket who practices with the team but does not play. Huawei has made improvements in their backup practices. They keep two extra CEOs in the team. They change the team every season so that everyone gets to play. Indian Premier League (IPL) might have got inspired from Huawei and introduced the concept of Impact player (substitute during the match).

Huawei first implemented a system of rotating Chief Operating Officers (COOs). Eight leaders were rotated and groomed on a COO role. Then the same system was implemented for CEOs. They rotate CEOs every six months. The organization is used to shared leadership and the shared decision making.

If you are impressed with the Huawei arrangement. Consider this. The Indian Cricket Board created the Indian Premier League, where multiple cricketers get a chance to showcase their talent. It has become the feeding ground for the Indian Cricket Team. Creating IPL is equivalent to succession planning. There is no dearth of talent. This arrangement ensures that the critical positions are never vacant. Even in the case of an accident or death of a critical position holder, the business runs as usual.

We will discuss the risk and mitigation of the accident and death in the next chapter.

Laws are the guide rails to create a balance.

Hands-on HR

Here are some hands-on questions for you to apply what you have learnt in this chapter.

1. Identify Critical Positions

Identify top 10 critical positions in the following organizations.

- Amway
- Zomato
- Hindalco
- Taj Hotels
- Life Insurance Corporation (LIC)

2. Succession Planning Toolkit

Please fill in the Succession Planning Toolkit for the HR Head role of a pharma organization. You may use the template from the University of Washington.

(<https://hr.uw.edu/pod/wp-content/uploads/sites/10/2018/08/Succession-Planning-Toolkit.pdf>)

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